A FREE GUIDE FROM DIVVYA ADLAKHA

Running on Empty

5 signs you're emotionally drained in your relationship, and what to do first.

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Tired isn't the same as "something's wrong with me."

Most people who reach this page aren't in a dramatic crisis. They're simply tired in a way sleep doesn't touch. They still love their partner. They still show up. But somewhere along the way, being in the relationship started to cost more than it gives back.

Emotional exhaustion rarely arrives all at once. It builds quietly, through hundreds of small moments where you swallowed a feeling, softened a need, or held the room together so no one else had to.

> Here's what I've learned from my own inner work and from walking alongside clients: drain is information, not failure. It points to a pattern. And patterns, once seen, can be changed.

This guide will help you recognise the five most common signs, understand what may be sitting underneath them, and take a few gentle first steps back towards yourself, before you try to fix anything else.

Read it slowly. Keep a pen nearby. Be honest, and be kind to yourself while you're at it.

With warmth,
Divvya

THE 5 SIGNS

Which of these feel familiar?

01

Being alone feels like relief, not rest

When your partner leaves the room, your shoulders drop. A cancelled plan feels like a gift. You're not avoiding them because you don't care. Your body has simply learned that being together means being "on."

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

Somewhere, connection got linked with effort: managing moods, anticipating needs, keeping the peace. Solitude has become the only place you get to stop performing.

ASK YOURSELF

What am I doing in their presence that I stop doing the moment I'm alone?

02

You rehearse conversations before you have them

You draft the message three times. You plan how to bring something up so it won't "start anything." Often, you decide it isn't worth it and say nothing at all.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

Self-editing is exhausting work. When honesty feels risky, your mind runs a constant background programme of prediction and protection, and that quietly drains you all day long.

ASK YOURSELF

What would I say right now if I knew it would be received with care?

03

Small things feel enormous

A dish left in the sink brings tears. A tone of voice ruins your evening. Later you think, "Why did I react like that?" and add guilt on top of the tiredness.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

It's rarely about the dish. When your emotional cup is already full, even one drop overflows. The reaction is pointing to everything that came before it, not just the moment itself.

ASK YOURSELF

The last time I overreacted, what was I really reacting to?

04

You've stopped asking for what you need

You give support, attention, effort and patience, but you've gone quiet about your own needs. Maybe you asked before and it didn't land. Maybe asking just feels like too much trouble now.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

Giving without receiving is like pouring from a cup no one refills. Over time, silence about your needs can turn into a belief that your needs don't matter, and that belief is heavy to carry.

ASK YOURSELF

When did I last ask for something just for me? What happened?

05

You can't remember who you are outside "us"

Your weekends, your friendships, your opinions, even your favourite food have slowly reshaped themselves around the relationship. When someone asks what you enjoy, you hesitate.

WHAT MAY BE UNDERNEATH

Closeness is beautiful, but merging is different. When your identity dissolves into the relationship, you lose the very inner well you'd normally draw energy from. You're running on their supply, not your own.

ASK YOURSELF

What did I love, believe or make time for before this relationship that I've quietly let go of?

QUICK CHECK-IN

Tick what's true for you right now

- ☐ I feel lighter when I'm on my own
- ☐ I edit myself before I speak to my partner
- ☐ Little things set me off more than they should
- ☐ I rarely ask for what I need anymore
- ☐ I've lost touch with parts of who I used to be

One or two ticks are a gentle nudge. Three or more suggest a pattern that deserves your attention, starting with the steps on the next page.

WHAT TO DO FIRST

Come back to yourself before you fix the relationship

When we feel drained, the instinct is to fix everything at once: the big talk, the ultimatum, the overhaul. But you can't make clear decisions from an empty tank. Begin here.

1. **Name it, without blame**
   Say it to yourself, or write it down: "I am emotionally tired." Not "they're draining me," not "I'm too sensitive." Just the truth. Naming a feeling calms the mind's alarm system and creates space to respond rather than react.

2. **Do a three-day energy audit**
   For three days, jot down the moments you feel drained and the moments you feel nourished: with your partner, at work, with family, alone. Look for the pattern, not the culprit. Often the drain is more specific than we think.

3. **Reclaim twenty minutes a day**
   Choose one small thing that belongs only to you: a walk, music, journaling, a quiet cup of chai. Protect it. This isn't selfish; it's how you start refilling the cup you've been pouring from.

4. **Say one honest sentence**
   Not a confrontation. Just one true, calm sentence to your partner when you're both relaxed:

   > *"I've been feeling a bit drained lately, and I'm working on looking after myself more. One thing that would really help me is _____."*

YOUR REFLECTION PAGE

Write it out

The moment this week I felt most drained was…

The moment I felt most like myself was…

A need I've been keeping quiet about is…

My twenty minutes this week will be…

A gentle note. Emotional tiredness is different from feeling unsafe. If you feel afraid of your partner, controlled, or unable to make your own choices, please reach out to someone you trust or a qualified professional. That's not something to work through alone.

YOUR NEXT STEP

The drain is the symptom. The pattern is the root.

If this guide felt a little too familiar, it's worth asking why. Emotional exhaustion in relationships rarely begins with your current partner. It often traces back to older patterns: how you learned to love, to give, to stay quiet, to keep the peace.

That's the work I do. I bring together psychology, NLP, shadow work and your karmic blueprint to help you see the pattern clearly, and then gently rewrite it.

The Pattern Method

A three-month inner work programme for people ready to stop repeating the same emotional cycles and come home to themselves.

Not sure where to start? Send me a message and tell me which sign hit closest to home. I read every one.

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You don't have to keep running on empty.

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